A quick read on the games market in this dataset

This dataset covers video game sales from 1980 to 2024, with title-level records that include console, genre, publisher, critic score, release timing, and regional sales. The clearest takeaway is that sales are highly uneven: a small number of blockbuster games and a handful of major platforms account for a large share of the market, while most titles sell modestly.

Most games sell modestly, with a few huge outliers

- Average total sales are **0.35**, but the median is only **0.12**
- Sales range from **0.00** to **20.32**
- The wide gap between the mean and median shows how much a few major hits pull the average upward

metric	total_sales
mean	0.34911267307895577
median	0.12
min	0.0
max	20.32
count_nonnull	18922.0

The sales distribution chart makes this pattern easy to see: most games cluster at the low end, and only a small number break out into very large totals.

The log version of the same chart helps show the spread among the many smaller-selling titles.

The biggest hits are led by a few blockbuster franchises

- **Grand Theft Auto V** appears three times in the top 10, across **PS3**, **PS4**, and **X360**
- **Call of Duty** also dominates the top ranks
- These best-sellers are concentrated on major console platforms and mostly come from a small set of publishers

title	console	total_sales	critic_score
Grand Theft Auto V	PS3	20.32	9.4
Grand Theft Auto V	PS4	19.39	9.7
Grand Theft Auto: Vice City	PS2	16.15	9.6
Grand Theft Auto V	X360	15.86	
Call of Duty: Black Ops 3	PS4	15.09	8.1
Call of Duty: Modern Warfare 3	X360	14.82	8.7
Call of Duty: Black Ops	X360	14.74	8.8
Red Dead Redemption 2	PS4	13.94	9.8
Call of Duty: Black Ops II	X360	13.86	8.4
Call of Duty: Black Ops II	PS3	13.8	8.0

Looking at regional mix for these top games, North America and PAL markets usually carry most of the weight, while Japan is much smaller for these particular blockbusters.

title	console	total_sales	na_sales
Grand Theft Auto V	PS3	20.32	6.37
Grand Theft Auto V	PS4	19.39	6.06
Grand Theft Auto: Vice City	PS2	16.15	8.41
Grand Theft Auto V	X360	15.86	9.06
Call of Duty: Black Ops 3	PS4	15.09	6.18
Call of Duty: Modern Warfare 3	X360	14.82	9.07
Call of Duty: Black Ops	X360	14.74	9.76
Red Dead Redemption 2	PS4	13.94	5.26
Call of Duty: Black Ops II	X360	13.86	8.27
Call of Duty: Black Ops II	PS3	13.8	4.99

PlayStation and Xbox platforms carry the largest sales totals

- **PS2** leads the dataset with **1027.76** in total sales
- **X360** and **PS3** follow closely behind
- The top platforms are dominated by PlayStation and Xbox generations

console	total_sales
PS2	1027.76
X360	859.79
PS3	839.7
PS	546.25
PS4	539.92

The console chart shows a clear drop after the top tier, with PS2 standing well ahead of the field.

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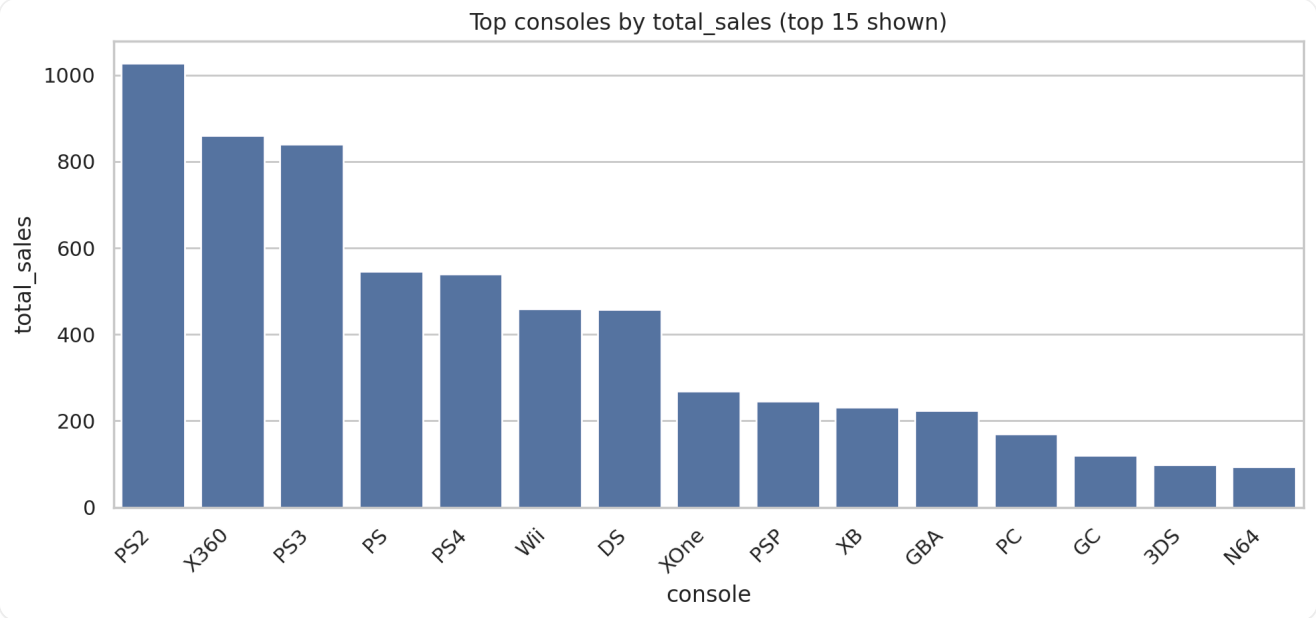

Sports, Action, and Shooter are the biggest genres overall

- **Sports** is the top genre at **1187.51**
- **Action** is close behind at **1125.89**
- **Shooter** ranks third with **995.50**

- These three genres make up the core of the market in this file

genre	total_sales
Sports	1187.51
Action	1125.89
Shooter	995.5
Misc	557.79
Racing	525.75

The genre chart reinforces how much these leading categories outpace the rest.

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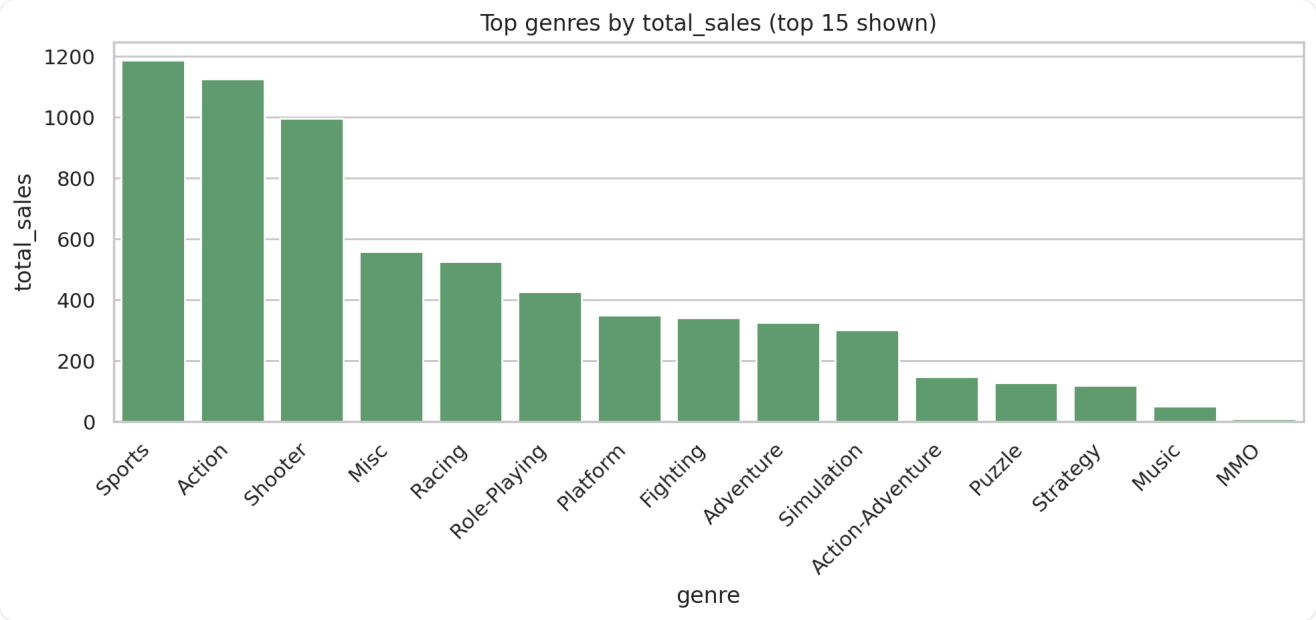

North America is the largest sales region by a wide margin

- **NA sales** contribute **50.68%** of the total regional sum
- **PAL** markets contribute **29.04%**
- **Japan** and **Other** each account for about one-tenth of the total

region	region_sales_sum	pct_of_regional_sum
na_sales	3345.52	50.6788701201713
pal_sales	1916.8300000000002	29.036675498113283

region	region_sales_sum	pct_of_regional_sum
jp_sales	687.94	10.421107005927523
other_sales	651.12	9.8633473757879

This regional split helps explain why many of the very top-selling games lean so heavily on North America and Europe.

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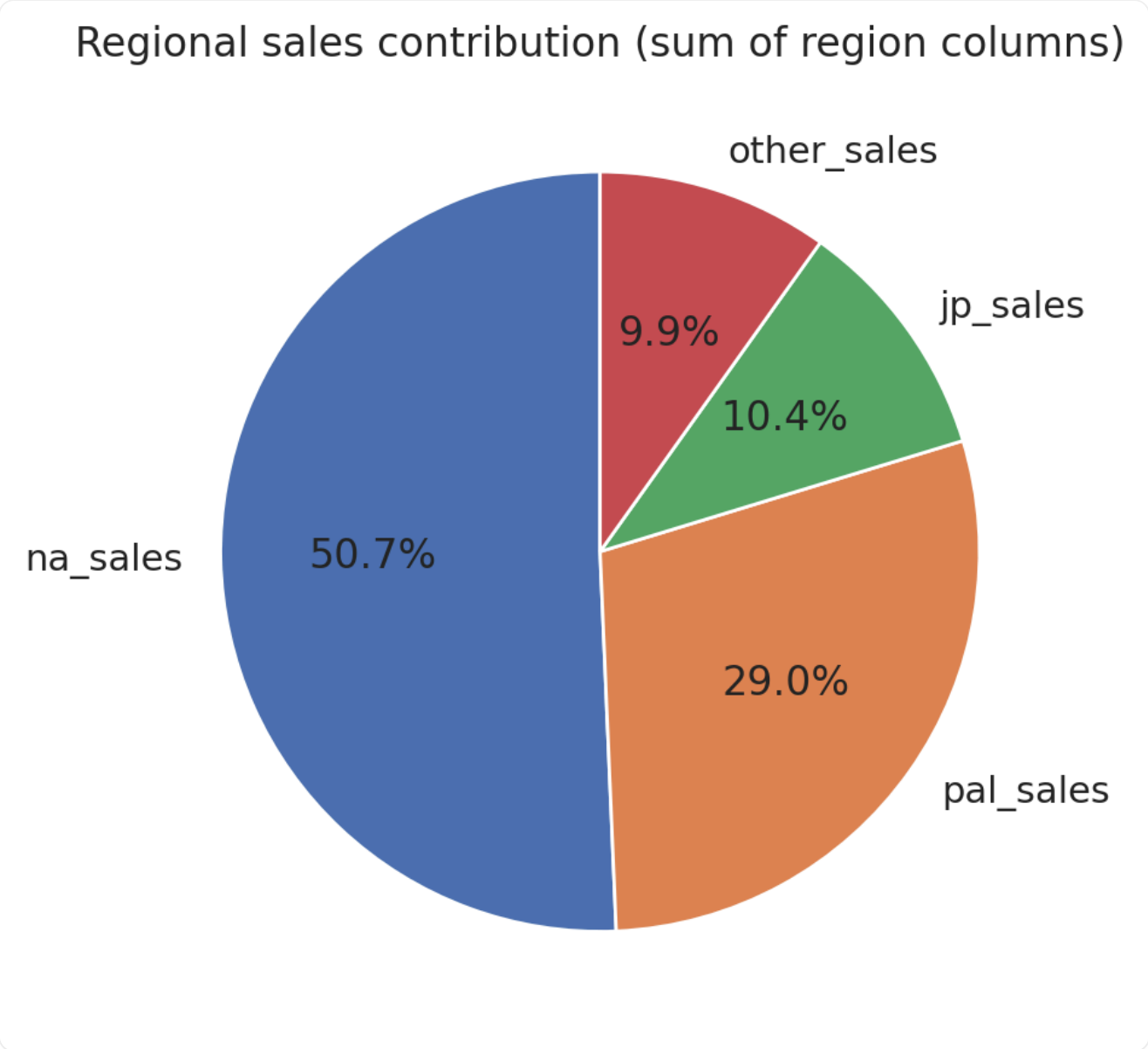

A few publishers account for much of the market's biggest sales

- **Activision** leads with **722.77**
- **Electronic Arts** follows with **644.13**

- **EA Sports** and **Ubisoft** also stand out
- Rockstar appears lower in total publisher sales than its blockbuster titles might suggest, showing how concentrated its success is in fewer massive hits

publisher	total_sales
Activision	722.77
Electronic Arts	644.13
EA Sports	485.66
Ubisoft	462.57
THQ	320.89
Sony Computer Entertainment	311.08
Rockstar Games	239.67
Konami	210.7
Sega	206.38
Nintendo	140.8

The publisher ranking chart shows a strong lead group before totals taper off.

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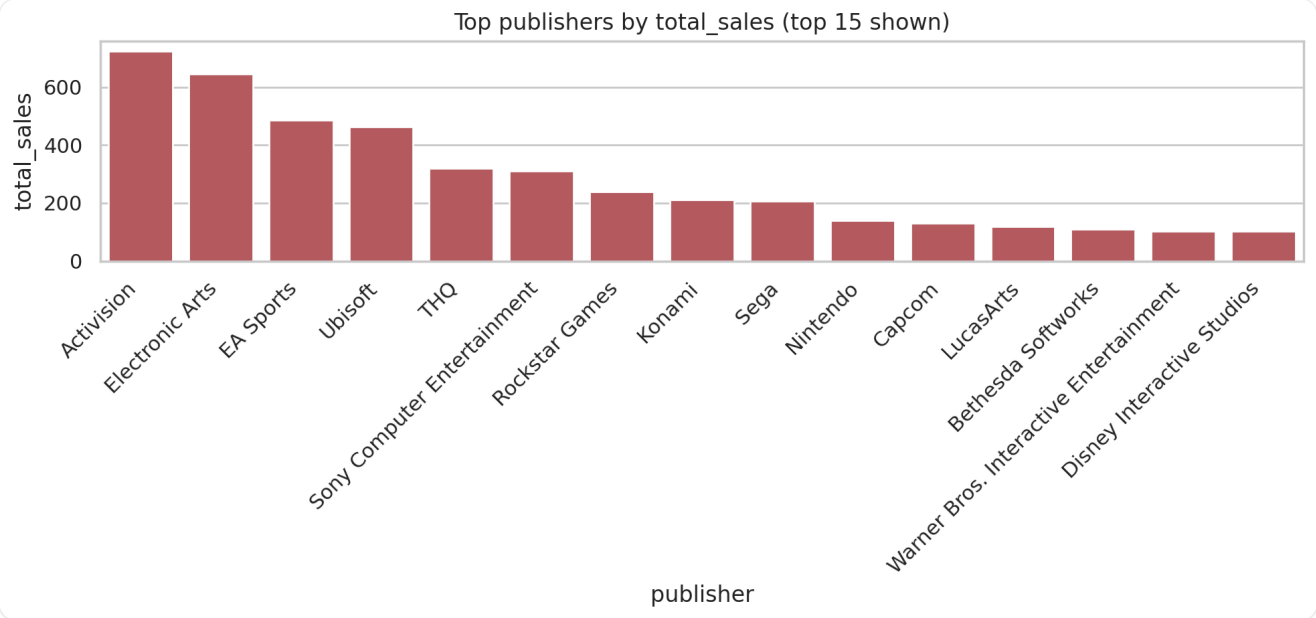

Better-reviewed games tend to sell more, but reviews are only part of the story

- The correlation between **critic_score** and **total_sales** is **0.281**
- That points to a positive relationship, but not a strong one
- In plain terms, stronger reviews help, but they do not explain success on their own

The scatter plot shows that high-selling games appear more often at higher review scores, but there is still a wide spread.

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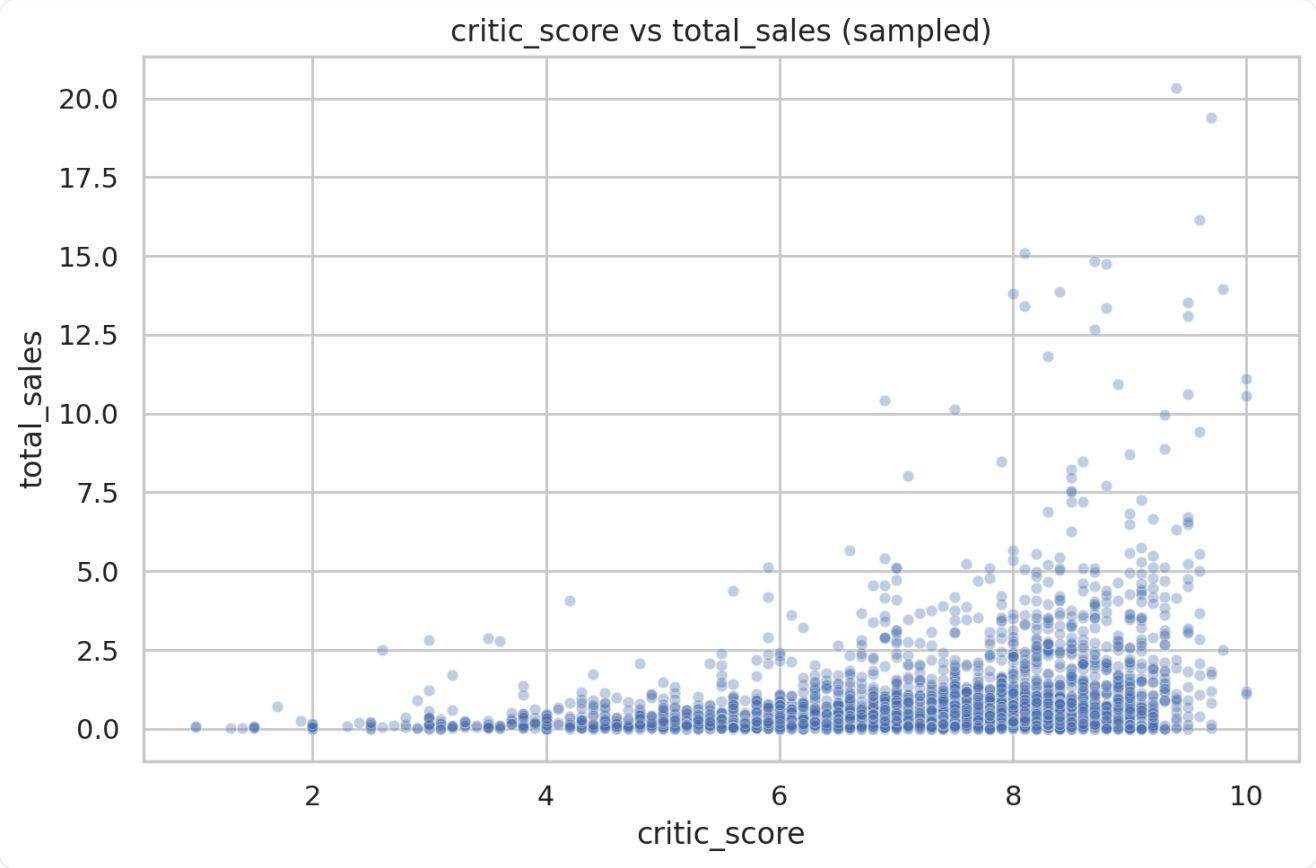

The log view makes the same pattern easier to see across the many lower-selling titles.

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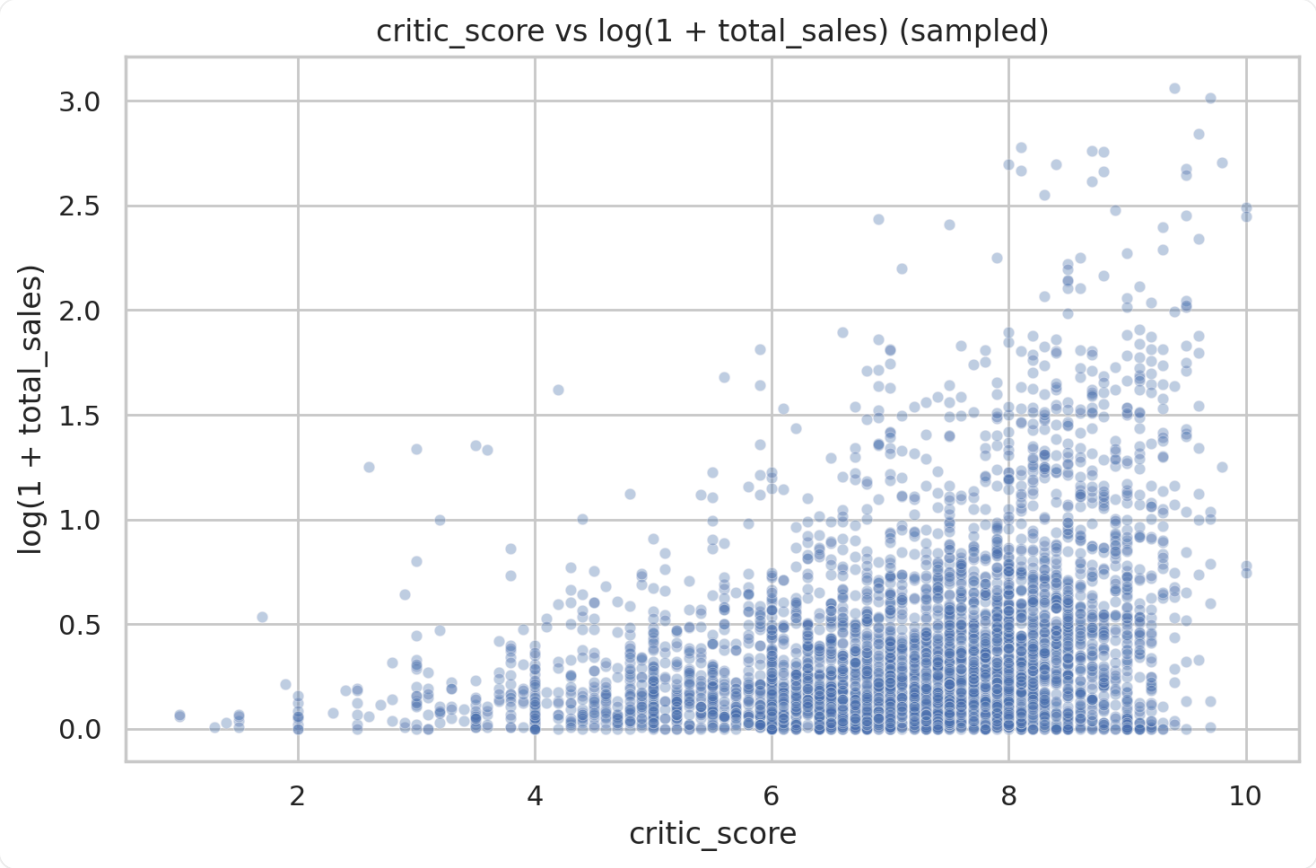

The biggest-selling years sit in the middle of the timeline, while the latest years appear incomplete

The year-level sales trend shows the market building over time and then tapering off in the most recent years. The final years in the dataset show very low or zero totals, which reads more like incomplete coverage than a true collapse in sales activity.

release_year	total_sales
1971.0	0.0
1973.0	0.0
1975.0	0.0
1977.0	2.5
1978.0	2.36

release_year	total_sales
2020.0	3.45
2021.0	0.0

release_year	total_sales
2022.0	0.0
2023.0	0.0
2024.0	0.0

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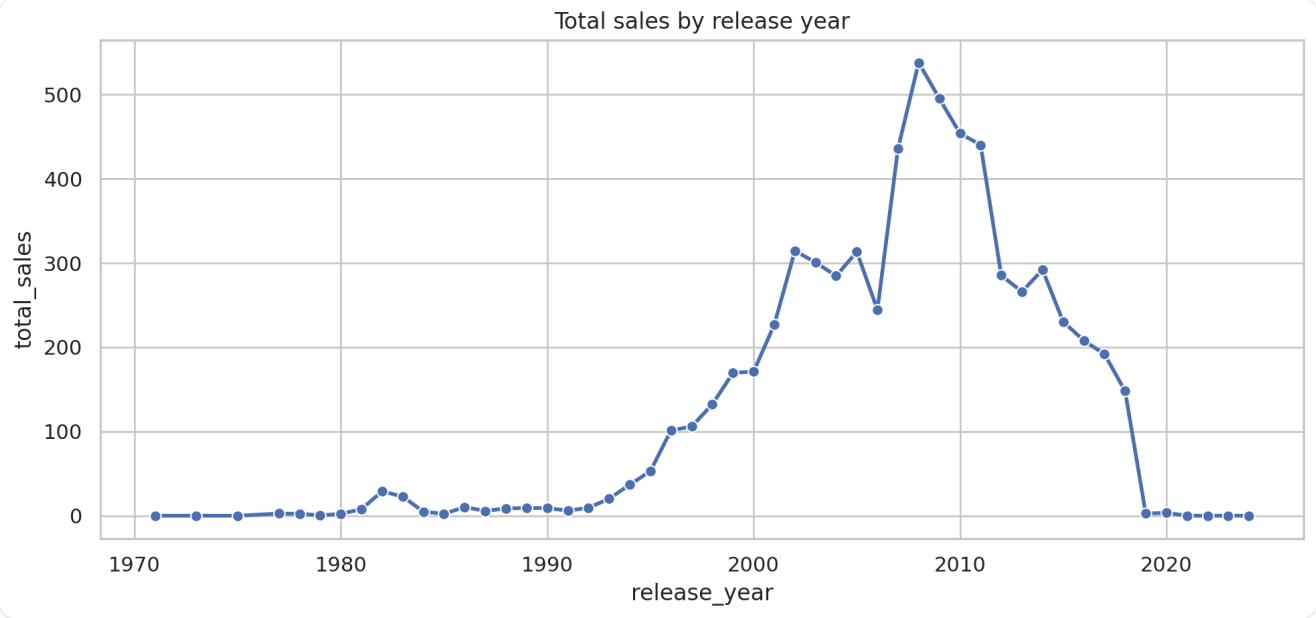

The top 10% of games look different from the rest

- The cutoff for the top 10% is **0.83** in total sales
- Top-10% games have a higher average critic score: **7.87** vs **7.11**
- Within this top tier, **Shooter**, **Sports**, and **Action** lead by sales
- The top-selling platforms within this group are again **PS2**, **X360**, **PS3**, and **PS4**

group	avg_critic_score	count_games
top_10_percent	7.873622881355932	1907
bottom_90_percent	7.1129054761074295	62109

genre	total_sales
Shooter	764.67
Sports	702.65

genre	total_sales
Action	653.0
Racing	304.65
Misc	270.05
Role-Playing	195.29
Fighting	188.36
Platform	168.14
Simulation	143.60999999999999
Adventure	138.88

console	total_sales
PS2	637.16
X360	616.88
PS3	593.18
PS4	421.27
PS	321.8
Wii	224.79
XOne	194.99
DS	154.42
PC	93.0
PSP	89.29

This reinforces a simple pattern: the biggest commercial winners are more likely to come from established platforms, familiar hit genres, and somewhat stronger review scores.

Update timing has almost no visible relationship with sales

- Among rows with both release and update dates, the correlation between update delay and sales is **0.002**

- Median update delay is **1179.5 days**
- Games with less frequent updates show slightly higher average and median sales, but the gap is small

update_group	avg_total_sales	median_total_sales	count_games
less_frequent_updates	0.42700431034482755	0.11	1856
more_frequent_updates	0.3842456896551724	0.07	1856

The scatter plot shows no meaningful pattern between the time to last update and total sales.

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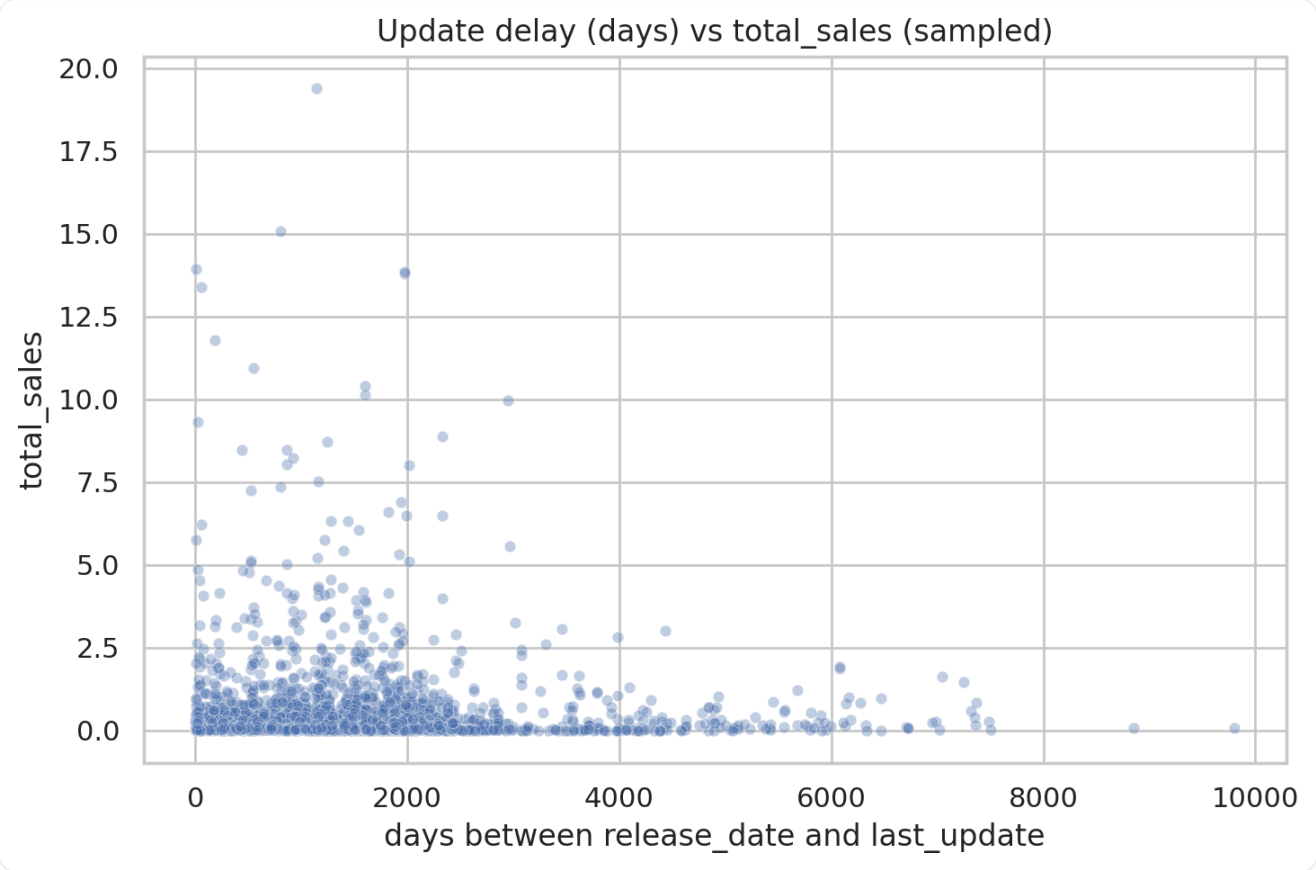

Closing view

Taken together, the dataset tells a familiar games industry story: a long tail of smaller sellers sits beneath a short list of blockbuster franchises, major consoles, and big publishers. PlayStation and Xbox platforms dominate cumulative sales, Sports, Action, and Shooter lead genres, North America is the largest regional market, and stronger critic scores help but do not guarantee

success. The biggest winners tend to come from proven platforms and genres, while update timing appears to have little direct connection to sales.